

Activity 1 - Authorise the HarbourHub Click & Collect Pilot

Course: Effective Project Management for Small Projects (TGS-2020505545) Topic: 1 | Initiation of a Project
Learning outcome: LO1 Duration: 75 minutes Team size: 3-4 learners Tool set: Project Charter, Cost-Benefit Analysis and Business Case templates

Objective

Develop project scope and team to initiate a five-month small project (A1, K1).

The situation

HarbourHub Fresh has approved discovery work for a click-and-collect pilot at three outlets, but the sponsor has not yet authorised delivery. Operations wants speed, Finance wants a hard S\$180,000 ceiling, store managers fear disruption, and customers want reliable collection times. Your team must decide whether this is a viable small project and define the authority to proceed.

What you will do

Validate the customer problem, quantify the investment case, define measurable success, set in/out boundaries, name the core team and sponsor, record assumptions and high-level risks, and prepare the kickoff decision.

What you will produce

A cost-benefit analysis, one-page business case and signed-ready project charter with measurable success criteria, scope boundaries, milestone dates, budget cap, team and kickoff agenda.

Tool files in this folder

- [`tools/02 Cost Benefit Analysis.xlsx`](#)
- [`tools/05 Business Case on a Page.docx`](#)
- [`tools/08 Project Charter Template.xlsx`](#)

Step-by-step instructions

1. Read the HarbourHub case and test it against the small-project criteria: temporary, unique, under six months, limited budget, limited interdependencies and no significant strategic impact.
2. Open the Design Thinking tool and capture the primary user: an outlet supervisor balancing walk-in customers, online orders and collection queues.
3. Write one evidence-based problem statement in the form: user + need + consequence. Do not embed a solution in the need.
4. Open 02 Cost Benefit Analysis.xlsx. Enter the S\$180,000 project cap, anticipated first-year benefits, transition costs and assumptions. Separate cash benefits from non-financial benefits.
5. Calculate net benefit, payback period and the sensitivity of the case to 20% lower order volume. Record which assumption is most decision-sensitive.
6. Complete 05 Business Case on a Page.docx: problem, options, recommended option, value, major risks and decision required.

7. Open 08 Project Charter Template.xlsx and define purpose, SMART success measures, in-scope deliverables and explicit exclusions.
8. Record the five-month milestone frame, S\$180,000 cap, major assumptions, constraints and the top three high-level risks.
9. Name one sponsor, one project manager and the seven-person core team. State the project manager's decision authority and escalation threshold.
10. Prepare a 15-minute kickoff agenda covering why, what, who, how, first decisions and immediate actions.
11. Run a sponsor gate review with another team. They may approve, approve with conditions or reject. Record the decision and conditions.

Evidence to submit

Complete [WORKSHEET.md](#) and attach/export the completed tool files named above.

Acceptance criteria

The charter proves the work qualifies as a small project, names one accountable sponsor, contains quantified success measures and exclusions, stays within five months and S\$180,000, and carries an explicit authorisation decision.

Debrief

- The business case answers whether the project should exist; the charter answers whether the team is authorised to act.
- A scope boundary is incomplete until exclusions are visible-silence is where scope creep starts.
- Success criteria must be measurable before the plan is built, or control later becomes opinion.

The full procedure is also reproduced in the Learner Guide, Activity 1. The trainer deck contains only the briefing and success criteria.